



Makerspaces approach learning as a byproduct of making. There is no curriculum or teacher but community members will help if and when you meet a roadblock

to audiences and designers upcycling junk to kitschy furniture. It's too early for makerspaces to zero in on the target audience for their offering. In fact, founders Chhabra and Pavan Kumar, cofounder of Bangalore's Workbench Projects say they spend most of their time explaining what a makerspace is. Maker's Asylum calls themselves a community makerspace; where they focus on "hands-on learning and creative problem solving". Workbench Projects, a registered fab lab in Bangalore promise to get that project "out of your head and into the world".

The concept of a makerspace comes from the hackerspace which started out as a European term for programmers who would gather and work together. And hence, both show similarities in ethics such as tendencies to opt for open source and community sharing.

Soon, US visitors returned home to emulate such events and organised hacks on their own. While it did start off predominantly with programmers, the communities soon moved on to working on circuit boards and real hardware to function in tandem with software. This shift from software to hardware is the crucial difference between hacker and maker spaces. It was a culmination of many things; the timing being most crucial. After the advent of the Internet, when consumers were satiated with giving real time feedback to brands, it was time to take things to the next level. Designers had had their feed with the software boom. And then digital manufacturing tools made an entrance. It connected designers to mini manufacturing